



# From "I want to hire" to a first legal paycheck in 30 days.

Written for the owner about to hire employee number one, who knows nothing about employer payroll and is afraid of the IRS. The fear is reasonable. The fix is a sequence, not a lawyer.

- The 30-day sequence: EIN, state accounts, workers' comp, provider, paperwork, first payroll, each with a "you're done when" checkpoint.
- The W-2 vs 1099 test, a payroll-provider comparison with dated pricing, and ICHRA and QSEHRA explained with the cost worked out.
- Every pay-stub line defined, the true hourly cost of a \$20-an-hour employee (\$22.52 before software or benefits), the filing calendar, and five first-timer mistakes with the one fix for each.

*Federal rules summarized from IRS, SSA and HHS pages as of the date printed inside. State and local rules can add to or change them. Information and planning tool only, not legal, tax or HR advice.*

WRITTEN BY A FINANCE EXECUTIVE

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A PROOFNOTFLUFF OPERATOR'S GUIDE

# First-Time Employer Payroll and Benefits Setup Guide

From "I want to hire" to a first legal paycheck in 30 days. Every step in order, nothing assumed, with four worksheets you fill in by hand.

## INSIDE



- The 30-day sequence
- W-2 or 1099? Ten questions
- Choosing a payroll provider
- Registering in your state
- ICHRA and QSEHRA, with the math
- Your first payroll, line by line
- The true hourly cost of a hire
- The filing calendar
- Five first-timer mistakes
- Four worksheets, worked examples

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